

KF45 Meeting Version of Teachings

Karis is an invitation to a relationship based on mutual generosity.

“Search me, O God, and know my heart. Examine me and know my thoughts. See if there is any way in me that causes pain, and lead me in the ways of eternity.” (Psalm 139:23–24)

0:01 OPENING

0:02 PRESENTING

0:06 KARIS CIRCULATION

0:07 GUIDELINES & LIMITATIONS

0:08 MINDFULNESS & MEDITATION TRAINING

I hope that you have taken a few minutes each day to practice **Alternate Nostril Breathing**. This breathing technique can help relax your body and refresh your mind. Not every technique works for everyone, so it is valuable to learn what works for you. We all have business to accomplish, and we all want to enjoy our business as much as we can. Mindfulness practices help us have a good time, more of the time, in the present time.

Let’s begin with a body scan to connect our minds to our marvelous bodies. Assume a meditation posture and breathe naturally for twenty seconds, allowing your body to regulate your breath. *(Pause for 20 seconds)*

Now turn your attention to your feet and ankles. What sensations do you notice there? *(Pause 20 seconds)*

Take a deep breath and move your attention to your calves and knees. Do you notice anything like discomfort, pain, or twitching? Breathe and observe. Try to relax on the exhale. *(Pause of 20 seconds)*

Now begin to observe your thighs and hips. What do you notice? As you exhale, release with the breath any tension or discomfort that you find. *(Pause 20 seconds)*

Move your attention to your torso. Scan your abdomen, chest, and back. Observe, and then with the breath release any tension. *(Pause 20 seconds)*

Move to your neck and shoulders. Breathe, adjust, and release. *(Pause 20 seconds)*

Observe your face. Breathe and relax any tightness or tension that you are holding there. *(Pause 20 seconds)*

Now we will move to **Alternate Nostril Breathing**.

Begin to breathe using alternate nostrils. You can breathe naturally, or you might use the **Three-Part**

Breath. We will practice for four minutes, and I will give you a two-minute marker. *(Pause for 4 minutes, announcing when two minutes have passed)*

Pause. Breathe gently. Notice how you feel. *(Pause)* Now, open your eyes and re-engage with the meeting.

Our hymn of gratitude is *Great Is Thy Faithfulness*. This famous hymn was written by Thomas Obadiah Chisholm, who was born in a log cabin in Kentucky. He served in Christian ministry until poor health presented to him other opportunities.

Great is Thy faithfulness, O God, my Father;
Morning by morning new mercies I see.
All I have needed Thy hand has provided;
Great is Thy faithfulness, Lord, unto me.¹

Take a deep breath.

(If time permits, ask, "Does anyone have comments or questions about this training?")

0:20 KARIS CONFESSION

0:21 TOOLBOX

We are exploring KF Confession 10:

We honor our limitations and seek lives of gratitude.

Doing the MATH is exactly like doing a financial budget, but when we budget our MATH, we not only honor the limitations of money, but also the limitations of our abilities, time, and health. We honor these limitations so that we can determine our priorities and make choices before we find ourselves in situations that demand an immediate or difficult decision. Our choices are then based on real evidence and not on the illusions generated by our pride system and our fears.

Honoring your limitations helps you communicate more authentically. Your *yes* becomes a real *yes* based on real MATH, and your *no* becomes a real *no*.² People then get to know you for who you really are. They come to understand your real limitations. Some people can't handle their own limitations, so they will not be able to handle yours. Since they believe that they, themselves, should be above limitations, they demand that you should be too, especially if they crave your immediate and unlimited support. This is particularly true in families and in organizations that depend on volunteers. If you have been willing to explore your limitations and have accepted that those limitations are your business, you will be more confident when you let others know where your boundaries lie. Breathe and connect with your priorities when others and your Idol are imposing their priorities on you.

In Western culture you will need help with budgeting your time. Use timers and alarms on your phone, your computer, or your watch, and buy individual timers at the store. When Nancy was parenting her young and very verbal son, she learned to set a timer to limit his chatter. He was allowed to talk for fifteen minutes, and then Nancy allowed herself thirty minutes of quiet. A timer gave her son the security of a boundary and an external authority that was not governed by his mother's whims or imagination. Both he and his mother agreed to be guided by this outside authority, and they both felt less anxiety. Nancy's son learned to relax because he could trust the timer to let them both know when he could talk again.

While he talked, Nancy was able to relax and be more respectfully engaged, knowing that her thirty minutes of quiet was not far away. By budgeting time in this way, Nancy was honoring both her son's and her own design and taking into account their current limitations.

When you know where your time is going, you can be more flexible, and you can confidently resist anything that might steal time. Overbooking is the same as going into time-debt. When your schedule is booked too tightly, you have no wiggle room to allow for the reality that events are not always under your control. You need to budget time for unplanned events, just as you need to save money for unplanned expenses. Unplanned events are a reality, so add fifteen minutes or even several hours here and there to give yourself margins.

You need to get real about time. If you are actively adventuring, you will encounter perils, and if you want to pass through those perils peacefully, you will need to have resources in reserve. Every morning or evening, prepare your plans with prayer. Budget time for the unexpected. Ask God to do all that He can do, and ask Him to guide you to do all that you can do. Planning your day before you begin the day gets the energy flowing in the direction of *your* business and *your* priorities. Calendars, schedules, and alarms are all tools for planning and budgeting time.

You are a creature with limitations. You need time to work, and you need time to rest and play. Balance is what you are looking for, but life will not balance itself. You have to make choices that will help maintain this balance. Some seasons and cycles can make greater demands on, or even drain, one or more areas of your MATH, and you will then have to consider how to redistribute your resources in order to bring some stability back into your life. Go joyfully into that training cycle because the current of the Creation will eventually reward you for your hard work. Our lives flow in tides, just like the sea. No sea creature fights the natural cycles of ebb and flow. Sea creatures take advantage of the flow when it comes so that they can replenish their resources and prepare for the ebb, which will also come. They circulate or restock according to the season, and flow with the cycles that come and go. Through their orientation to the Creation, they naturally know how to trust the authority of the tide. We are creatures, too, but our idolatry resists the natural circulation of the Creation. We can, however, get back in harmony with the Creation by choosing to honor the real limitations of time and of flow.

Our prayer might go something like this:

Wise Creator, move me into the flow of the Creation. (Repeat)

Take a deep breath.

(If time permits, ask, "Does anyone have comments or questions about the Toolbox?")

0:30 SHARING

1:00 BIBLE TEACHING

In his letter to the Ephesians, Paul reminds us that Christians have always lived in misoriented cultures. Today, our culture is busy brainwashing us with the illusion that we can live a life without limitations. The market economy carefully fosters that illusion because it wants us to spend. Our society promotes the careless use of resources and then judges the real consequences of that carelessness as unfair. The Bible makes it clear, however, that no one gets away with anything. Ignoring your limitations will damage you and your community. As a Christian, you cannot afford to get caught up in cultural illusions. Misorientation

is all around you, so you must make it your business to defend and train the unique and precious creature that you are.

Let's look at Nancy's translation and paraphrase of **Ephesians 5:13–18**.

¹³All reprovable things are revealed for what they are when they are exposed to the light. Or we could put it this way—everything that is revealed becomes a guiding light. ¹⁴For this reason it has been said, “Awake, sleeper. Arise from the insensible dead and Christ will illuminate you.” His light will reveal the truth about you, and that truth will guide you to become more like Him. ¹⁵See that you walk around precisely, mindfully, and sharp-sightedly, not as foolish people without wisdom. Walk wisely. ¹⁶Walking wisely will buy back the time wasted in time-debt. You must take control of your time because the times that we live in are very misoriented, and that environmental misorientation will seek to drive you into misorientation. ¹⁷Since this is true, do not be mindless and egocentric. Rather, cooperate with what the Lord desires—your orientation. ¹⁸Stop wasting your resources like a foolish drunk person. This kind of wasteful mindlessness fractures the soul. Instead, unify your soul by walking around mindfully and precisely, filled with the Spirit of God.

Take a deep breath.

In this passage, Paul gives us guidance that helps us manage all of our resources, especially the resource of time.

1. We must allow every area of our lives to be revealed for what it is

How are you using your time? Is it possible that you are using your time to save your Idol's life?

2. Wake up! Get real! Engage!

Allow the light of Jesus to shine on your life. Compare your life with His, and talk to Him about your training for today. Ask Him what qualities He would like to develop in your life.

3. Walk around, but do it carefully and mindfully

You must take control of how you use your time or else the market economy and your compelling needs will do it for you. They will steal your time in order to impose their priorities on you. You know the areas of your life that get hijacked by mindless living. Plan ahead. Snatch that time away from the jaws of the market and from your Idol's mindless craving so that you can use your time for God's purposes and for your own.

4. Cooperate with God

Rather than fighting against the currents of your life, learn to go with God's flow and stay connected to His guidance. The flags of discouragement, frustration, and chronic self-hate will let you know that you are fighting against the current or swimming against the tide. On many occasions, Nancy has reluctantly chosen to let go of projects because of limited time. She has then witnessed God and the community competently manage the necessary projects on their own. Ask God and others for help, and do your best to create a balance of work and rest in your own life. It is through engaging with your limitations that you learn to trust God's ability to support you.

Our prayer might go something like this:

God and Creator, unite my heart to go peacefully with the flow. (Repeat)

Take a deep breath.

(If time permits, ask, "Does anyone have comments or questions about the Bible teaching?")

1:10 INTEGRATION

Sip some purified water and assume a meditation posture. Breathe and relax. *(Pause for 10 seconds)*

Here is our integration focus: *Consider the limitation of time in an area of your life. (Repeat) (Pause for 30 seconds)*

The FAITH Process

Feelings

As you *consider the limitation of time in an area of your life*, how does it feel? *(Pause)* Your feelings are yours to teach you about yourself, to guide you, and to train you. They can often be uncomfortable. *(Pause)* Recognize with compassion whatever you are experiencing, and breathe. *(Pause for 30 seconds)*

Awareness without judgment

Allow this experience to remain in your awareness as you *consider the limitation of time in this area*. Observe whatever tension you may be feeling as you hold your experience up to the light. *(Pause)*. Give yourself permission now to explore without judgment, and breathe. *(Pause for 30 seconds)*

Inquiry: What is my body saying?

Bring your attention to your body and notice what it is doing when you *consider the limitation of time in this area of your life*. What sensations are there? *(Pause)* Your body is always talking to you. For example, you might recognize what denial or stress feels like in your body. Breathe. *(Pause for 30 seconds)*

Talk to Jesus

You might imagine that you are leaning back in the safe and loving arms of Jesus as together you *consider this limitation of time*. Jesus might be asking if you feel comfortable, uncomfortable, or numb. Just observe. *(Pause)* Do you feel compelled to judge limitations of time as good or evil? *(Pause)* Do you feel entitled to use time in any way you like without adverse consequences? *(Pause)* Is this a regular pattern for you? *(Pause)* Observe your experience as just information. You might process with a long exhaling breath or the Dragon Breath. *(Pause for 30 seconds)*

Heal

As you breathe, repeat the word *Welcome*. *(Pause for 10 seconds)*

(Pause for 8 seconds or one long breath after each statement)

- Welcome this opportunity to explore an area of limited time.
- Welcome the Holy Spirit of truth, who loves the material creature that you are, living in time.
- Welcome your present reality, where you are today.
- Welcome what you are learning about yourself. *(Pause for 10 seconds)*

Now, as you breathe, you might use the following statements as a confession to the Lord and turn away from the Idol Self. On the exhale, let go.³

(Pause for 5 seconds after each statement)

- As I accept the limitations of time, I let go of the craving to get my own way.
- As I accept the limitations of time, I let go of the craving to gain approval.
- As I accept the limitations of time, I let go of the craving for security and comfort.
- As I accept the limitations of time, I let go of the craving for perfection. *(Pause for 30 seconds)*

(Optional) Continue to breathe while I test for further integration.

Take a deep breath.

(If time permits, ask, "Does anyone have comments or questions about the integration?")

1:28 ENDING PRAYER

Dear Father and Creator,

Thank You for drawing us together for support and healing. Hold us in the power of this new understanding as we learn to manage our time. Lead us to the next step in our healing this week as we co-labor with You to reorient our lives for a more effective flow and to further our connection with our True Self and mission, with the Creation and our community, and with You, for the glory and honor of our Lord Jesus. Amen.

Take a deep breath.

(If time permits, ask, "Does anyone have comments or questions about this meeting?")

1:29 ANNOUNCEMENTS

¹ *Great is Thy Faithfulness* by Thomas Chisholm (1866–1960), www.youtube.com/watch?v=dTKlqmdfHSk.

² Matt. 5:37.

³ www.camillecaldwell.com/WelcomePrayer.html. Adapted for Karis Fellowships by Nancy Diven.